

Retailer Depth-Interview Guide

Qualitative Research (Malhotra Chapter 4) - Danone Egypt Distribution Project

Interviewer: _____ Date: _____ Shop area: () City centre ()
Town / suburb () Village / rural

Method

Semi-structured, one-to-one depth interview, about 10 to 15 minutes. Talk to the owner of a small grocery store. Take notes (or record with permission). Aim for 3 to 5 retailers, mixing at least one city shop and one village shop. Goal: understand the supply side, that is, why small shops stock Juhayna more readily than Danone.

Before you start

Introduce yourself and the academic purpose, promise confidentiality, and ask permission to take notes.

Shop profile (warm-up)

1. How long have you run this shop? Roughly how many customers a day?

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2. Roughly what share of your sales is dairy and yogurt?

Brands stocked

3. Which yogurt and dairy brands do you currently stock? (let them list freely)

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4. Which one sells the most? Why do you think that is?

The core: Danone vs Juhayna

5. Do you stock Danone? Why or why not?

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6. How often does the Juhayna sales rep / van visit you? And the Danone one?

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7. Who delivers to your door, and who do you have to order or collect from yourself?
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8. Differences in minimum order size, payment terms (cash vs credit), returns of expired stock, and fridge or cooler provided by the company?

9. Which company is easier to deal with, and why?

Demand vs availability

10. Do customers ever ask for Danone when you don't have it? What do they do then?

11. If Danone were as easy to get and as well-supported as Juhayna, would you stock more of it?

Wrap-up

12. In one sentence: what is the main reason Juhayna is on more shelves than Danone?

13. Anything else about dealing with dairy companies you would want them to know?

Arabic field cheat-sheet

Useful phrasings to ask the questions naturally:

(?which yogurt brands do you stock) بتجيب أنواع زبادي إيه؟

(?how often does the Juhayna rep visit? and Danone) مندوب جهينة بيعدي عليك كل قد إيه؟ ودانون؟

do customers ask for Danone when it is not available? what do) العميل بيطلب دانون ومش بتلاقيه؟ بيعمل إيه ساعتها؟
(?they do

(?main reason Juhayna is in more shops than Danone) إيه أكثر سبب إن جهينة موجودة في محلات أكثر من دانون؟

How these findings feed the report

Code the answers into themes: rep / van visit frequency, delivery and terms, fridge support, customer demand pull, and margins. Quote two or three exact lines per theme. Use them in Chapter 4 to explain why the availability gap measured in the survey exists.